

On Wavelength

Group calendar with heatmap voting and a full sport-coach workflow for 8 sports.

What it is

On Wavelength is an iOS and Android calendar app with two pillars. Pillar one is heatmap voting for group dates: every member taps when they are free, the app shows the best shared slot, the group chat stays quiet. Pillar two is a sport-coach workspace for 8 sports (soccer, volleyball, basketball, handball, hockey, badminton, tennis, running) covering training and match planning, lineups, live attendance and a drill library.

Who it is for

Two audiences. Amateur sport coaches across the 8 sports and run-club coaches are the highest converters (3-5% reel-views to install in our test cohort). Flatshares, friend groups, families and productivity-curious creators are broader but convert at ~0.5-1%. A single coach brings 8-16 active users on average (their team), so coach attribution compounds; productivity reach keeps the funnel filled between coach campaigns.

Key features

- Heatmap voting on every group, weekly slot detection without chat back-and-forth.
- Colour-coded group calendar with shared events.
- Sport-team workspace: trainings, matches, lineups, live attendance, reminders.
- Drill library across 8 sports, session builder in 4 minutes.
- Season planner: matches + duplicated trainings + imported roster in 20 minutes.
- Multi-group: one coach with several teams plus a private flatshare circle in the same app.

Business model

- Single revenue stream: recurring Premium subscription.
- Free tier is generous: full heatmap voting, one calendar, one group up to 4 members.
- Premium unlocks: unlimited groups, sport-team workspace, drill library, live attendance, season planner.
- Free Lifetime Premium for onboarded affiliates, no posting obligation.

Pricing

- ~5 EUR / month (no annual lock-in).
- ~40 EUR / year (~ two months free vs monthly).
- ASC live since May 2026; affiliate share is always 50% of the then-current price.

Market gap - what was missing

Heatmap voting for group dates has been an open gap in the calendar space for years. The dominant calendars (Google, Apple, Outlook) do not ship heatmap voting - it is too niche for a horizontal product. Doodle exists but lives as a URL-poll, sits outside any actual calendar, expects no account, and never becomes a calendar overlay you can plan around. On the sport-coach side, TeamSnap and SportEasy dominate the US and parts of Western Europe, but adoption in the DACH region is thin: TeamSnap is heavily US-focused, SportEasy is priced for clubs not amateur coaches, and the drill libraries that exist are mostly federation-locked PDF archives. So you have two audiences (coordination-pained groups + amateur coaches) that buy a calendar app the moment it solves their specific pain. We built one product that serves both, because the coordination engine (heatmap + multi-group) is what both audiences need.

Why now

Two structural shifts make this work in 2026. First, iOS Universal Links and Android install-referrer have matured enough that DIY attribution is reliable (the missing piece - iOS cold install - we solved with a clipboard deferred-deeplink, verified live for months). That means we can run 50% rev-share with no agency layer, which was not economically viable when paid attribution SDKs cost 0.20-0.40 USD per attributed install. Second, RevenueCat plus pg_cron plus Wise let a solo operator run a full webhook-to-payout pipeline without managed payout infrastructure. The technical floor for this kind of niche-tool affiliate program dropped enough that small teams can offer terms (50% / 24 months / Wise direct) that were previously reserved for big SaaS.

Affiliate compensation

- 50% of net Premium subscription revenue for 24 months from each attributed user's first paid month.
- 30-day refund holdback before payout becomes claimable (Apple / Google refund window).
- 50 EUR minimum payout, monthly, via Wise.
- Free Lifetime Premium for onboarded affiliates (no posting obligation).
- Per-handle dashboard with live click / install / sub / earning split, no agency layer.

How tracking works - DIY attribution stack

Most affiliate stacks ride on top of Branch.io, AppsFlyer or a similar paid attribution SDK. We built our own. The reason is simple: those tools charge per attributed install, they add a third party to the user's first-launch experience, and they make influencer payouts opaque. We wanted full control of every step from click to Wise transfer. The full path has six stages - link click, install, first launch attribution, Premium purchase, holdback, payout. Here is what runs in each stage.

Why we built our own instead of Branch.io

Three reasons. (1) Cost: Branch.io and AppsFlyer charge 0.20-0.40 USD per attributed install at our volume tier, which would have absorbed roughly 8-12% of the affiliate payout pool. With DIY we keep that for affiliates. (2) Privacy: each additional SDK reads first-launch context (device fingerprint, IP, locale, install timestamp) - that is another vendor with first-touch user data we did not want to add. Apple's App Tracking Transparency framework has also made probabilistic fingerprinting unreliable since iOS 14.5; the paid SDKs work around this with their own opaque heuristics that we could not audit. (3) Transparency: when a dashboard number looks wrong, we read our own code in 10 minutes instead of debugging a third-party black box. The trade-off is that we own the bugs. We are okay with that - every line of the attribution code is in our repo.

Android: Google Play install-referrer

Android gives us the cleanest path. When a user taps your link, the Google Play Store install carries the original referrer string (a URL-encoded query parameter from the redirect chain) through to first launch via the Play Install Referrer API. On first launch the app reads `getInstallReferrer().getInstallReferrer()`, we parse the handle and source out of it, and write an `attribution` row in our Supabase table alongside the install event. Deterministic. No fingerprinting. No clipboard. Google guarantees the referrer string is preserved across the install hop, so this works for every Android install reached via your link.

iOS warm (app already installed)

If the user already has Wavelength installed (a small minority of creator traffic, mostly your existing followers), iOS routes the tap through a Universal Link directly into the app with the handle in the URL path. We register `onwavelength.space/i/*` as a Universal Link in the iOS entitlements file, Apple's CDN serves the `apple-app-site-association` JSON we publish at the domain root, and the OS routes the tap. Inside the app, the deep-link handler reads the URL path, extracts the handle, and writes the attribution row. Deterministic.

iOS cold (~99% of creator traffic)

The hard case - and ~99% of creator traffic - is iOS cold install. iOS gives the freshly installed app no context about how it was reached. Branch.io's whole business is solving this with device-fingerprinting heuristics that became increasingly unreliable after iOS 14.5 (App Tracking Transparency). We do it differently. When a user taps your link in Safari, our redirect chain hits a landing page at `onwavelength.space/i/[handle]`. That page writes a short-lived JSON token to the clipboard before redirecting to the App Store. The token contains: handle, timestamp (issued-at), app-key, version, and an HMAC-SHA256 signature computed against a server-side secret. After install, on first launch, the app reads the clipboard once (Apple shows the standard clipboard-paste system UI), parses the JSON, verifies the signature against the public verification logic, accepts the token if it is freshly signed and less than 7 days old, and writes the attribution row. The user sees no extra screen when it works. If the clipboard is empty or the token is invalid, we fall back silently to the confirmer step (next sub-section). We have live-verified this exact flow against the Wavelength app continuously for months.

Optional first-open confirmer

Optional fallback. On first open, after we have read whatever the clipboard provided, the app shows a single confirmation line: "Invited by @[suggested-handle]? Yes / No". The handle field is pre-filled with whatever the clipboard suggested; if the clipboard was empty, the field is empty and the user can type. Most users tap Yes. This catches the edge case where Apple's clipboard-access dialog was denied, the user copied something else between tap and install, or the clipboard expired. The step is opt-in per app: Wavelength runs it on, MyLoo runs it off (medical context, different UX trade-off). Toggleable in the app config without an app update.

RevenueCat webhook -> payout queue

Premium purchases flow through RevenueCat. RC handles Apple StoreKit and Google Play Billing receipts, dedup, refund detection, and converts everything into a consistent webhook event format. When a `INITIAL_PURCHASE`, `RENEWAL`, `PRODUCT_CHANGE`, or `CANCELLATION` event fires, RC posts JSON to our Supabase Edge function `affiliate-rc-webhook`. The function (1) verifies the RC signature header against our shared secret to confirm authenticity, (2) idempotency-checks the event ID against the `processed_webhook_events` table to avoid double-credit on RC retries, (3) looks up the user's attribution row (`user_id` -> `attributed_handle`), (4) computes 50% of the net revenue after Apple's or Google's 15-30%

Why this works as an affiliate pitch

Sport coaches solve a real recurring pain (no-shows, lineup chaos, drill planning) and convert above average - and crucially they bring their team, so a single coach is worth 8-16 active users. Productivity / flatshare audiences convert at a lower rate but reach is much larger, which keeps the funnel filled between coach campaigns. Heatmap voting demos cleanly on screen-record, which means even faceless creators get a visually strong asset out of the app. The 50% / 24-month / Wise-direct payout structure is unusual for an app of this size, which is the structural advantage we built the attribution stack to make economically possible.

On posts with affiliate link: #ad / #sponsored / Paid Partnership (FTC, EU disclosure law).